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Toh 534 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 534 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as the Essence of the Noble Śākyamuni, corresponding to the Sanskrit designation Āryaśākyamunidhāraṇī, and it belongs to the broader category of dhāraṇī literature within the canon. The text presents a concentrated ritual formula invoking the purifying power of the Buddha Śākyamuni alongside homages to the Tathāgata Vairocana and the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha, promising that recitation of its mantra will cleanse even grave accumulations of non-virtuous deeds. It further assures practitioners of protection from physical dangers — weapons, fire, water, and poison — as well as from human adversaries such as kings and thieves. As a dhāraṇī sūtra, it exemplifies the genre of compact, apotropaic scripture found throughout the Kangyur's collection of protective and purificatory texts.

All non-virtuous deeds committed up to eight hundred seats of wrongdoing shall be entirely purified. This concludes the dhāraṇī of the essence of the noble Śākyamuni.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the noble Vairocana, King of Light.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Ākāśagarbha (Space-Matrix).

tadyathā — kala kala, kili kili, biri biri, huru huru, vairocana-raśmi-sañcodite
āgaccha, ārya ākāśagarbha mahākāruṇika pūraya haśāna, dhāraya buddhe
viśvaya na, cara cara, ciri ciri — svāhā.

Whoever recites this accomplishes its purpose: weapons, fire, water, poison, poisoned preparations, and harmful rituals shall have no power over them. Kings, thieves, and all such adversaries shall find no opportunity against them. In whatever place this is written and kept there —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end ("In whatever place this is written and kept there —"), indicating this is a partial passage and the continuation is not present in the supplied text.

The phrase rendered "eight hundred seats of wrongdoing"

(□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is formulaic dhāranī literature and the precise

idiomatic meaning of "ཀློང་རྒྱ་བདུན་བརྒྱ་ལྔ་སྟེང་གི།" (literally "eight hundred myriads" or "up to eighty-thousand") as a numerical boundary for sins purified may warrant comparison with parallel Sanskrit witnesses; the rendering here follows the most natural reading of the Tibetan.

The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering into standard Sanskrit approximations and are not emended beyond what the Tibetan orthography clearly supports.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.